

Ansible Tech Test: Ansible Repo to Provision monitoring_servers inventory group

Control Node Setup:

- Install ansible-core 2.17:

Done on test machine with directions from here:

https://docs.ansible.com/projects/ansible/latest/installation_guide/intro_installation.html#installing-and-upgrading-ansible-with-pipx

Ansible Collection Installation:

- Install the collections for: `community.docker` and for `ansible.posix.authorized_key` with ansible galaxy, in `collections/requirements.yml`
 - Install with `ansible-galaxy collection install -r collections/requirements.yml`

Resource Explanation:

- `community.docker`
 - Using the collection instead of using shell scripts should work better with the strategy of idempotent server changes, and is more consistent with other task definitions.
- `ansible.posix.authorized_key`
 - Used to be a built-in module, and now isn't. The safety features of ensuring that it will not disrupt any existing SSHkeys on the host machine seems like a good trade off for slower performance than a shell script.

Executing Playbook:

- The `group_vars/monitoring_servers.yml` file has been encrypted with an ansible-vault pass word. The password is "offworld".
- Can be run with the command: ``ansible-playbook --ask-vault-pass -i inventory.ini ProvisionMachine.yml`` and then entering the vault password.

- This seemed like the most secure way to handle the passwords and keep them secure.

Interacting with the repo, and what changes to make for production environment:

- Change server addresses in Inventory.ini need to be updated to the list of production sever IPs, or other method of collecting server IP's.
- **Human Admin SSH Key:** The [offworld admin ssh keys](#) variable in `group_vars/all.yml` is a temporary SSH key that was made for testing.
- The files in the templates folder: `host-custom-dashboard.json` and `host-docker-dashboard.json` are easy to replace with dashboards that are designed to the team's liking.
 - Grafana dashboards can be configured manually on the host machines, and then their configuration can be copied as code, and pasted into a new dashboard.json file.
- If changes to the encrypted file is necessary, it can be decrypted with:
 `ansible-vault decrypt group_vars/monitoring_servers.yml`
 enter password: offworld
 (Make changes to the file)
 `ansible-vault encrypt group_vars/monitoring_servers.yml`
 enter and confirm new password

Notice:

- The docker image for Grafana's default account has been replaced. Username is `admin`, password is located in the encrypted `monitoring_servers.yml`, and is `Shale1Maple2Snort`